

Word family: **allow** / **allows** / **allowed** / **allowing** / **allowance** / **allowances** / **allowable** / **disallow** / **disallowed** / **disallowance**

Base word: **allow**

Part of speech: mainly **verb**

Related forms:

* **allow** (v.) — 允許；准許；容許；讓；使成為可能；考慮到；承認

* **allowed** (adj./participle) — 獲准的；容許的

* **allowing** (participle) — 容許；讓

* **allowance** (n.) — 津貼；零用錢；限額；免稅額；容許量；考慮；寬容

* **allowable** (adj.) — 容許的；可接受的；可扣除的

* **disallow** (v.) — 不准許；駁回；判定無效

* **disallowed** (adj./participle) — 不獲准的；被判無效的

* **disallowance** (n.) — 不准許；否決；不予認可

Major useful extensions:

allow someone to do something, **be allowed** to do something, **allow** something, **allow** access, **allow** entry, **allow** time, **allow** enough time for, **allow** someone something, **allow** yourself something, **allow** yourself to do something, **allow** for, **allow** for delays, **allow** for differences, **allow** of, **allow** that, **allow** a claim, **allow** an appeal, **allow** an expense, **allow** a deduction, **allow** a goal/run/hit, **not allowed**, **no X allowed**, **smoking allowed**, **maximum allowed**, **legally allowed**, **allowed value/range**, **allowance**, **weekly/monthly allowance**, **pocket-money allowance**, **travel allowance**, **housing allowance**, **meal allowance**, **clothing allowance**, **baggage allowance**, **duty-free allowance**, **tax allowance**, **personal allowance**, **capital allowance**, **allowance for doubtful accounts**, **make allowance for**, **make allowances for**, **allowance for error**, **tolerance allowance**, **seam allowance**, **machining allowance**, **allowable cost**, **allowable expense**, **allowable limit**, **allowable error**, **allowable stress**, **disallow** a claim, **disallow** an expense, **disallow** a goal, **disallowed deduction**.

Meaning in this passage

Your passage uses **allow** twice in closely related ways:

> At issue is not whether customers should **be allowed** to change their minds without limit...

and:

> Customers should **be allowed** one exchange for size or colour if the item is unworn and unwashed.

The central meaning is:

to give someone permission to do or have something — 允許；准許；容許

In the first sentence:

be allowed to change their minds = 獲准改變主意

In the second:

be allowed one exchange = 獲准有一次換貨機會

So the grammar changes:

> **allow someone to do X**

> **allow someone X**

but the core meaning stays:

granting permission or entitlement

A. ALLOW SOMEONE TO DO SOMETHING

1. **allow someone to do something — 允許某人做某事**

This is the most important construction and the exact passage branch.

Practice 1 — original sentence

> Customers should **be allowed to change their minds**.

顧客應該**獲准改變主意**。

Practice 2

> The policy allows customers to exchange the item once.

政策**容許顧客換貨一次**。

Practice 3

> Staff are not allowed to approve refunds without inspection.

員工在未檢查商品前**不得批准退款**。

MCQ-ready definition:

allow someone to do X = 給某人做 X 的許可 / 權利

2. **be allowed to do something — 獲准做某事**

Passive construction, extremely common.

Practice 1

> Customers are **allowed to return defective items**.

顧客**可以 / 獲准退回有缺陷商品**。

Practice 2

> Employees are allowed to exercise discretion in exceptional cases.

員工在特殊個案中**獲准酌情處理**。

3. **not be allowed to do something — 不得做某事**

Practice 1

> Customers are **not allowed to return worn clothing**.

顧客**不得退回穿過的衣物**。

Practice 2

> Staff are not allowed to remove evidence from the case file.

員工**不得移除個案檔案中的證據**。

4. **allow someone to + verb — grammar pattern**

Correct:

> allow customers **to exchange** items

Not:

> *allow customers exchange items* ❌

The infinitive normally requires:

to

Compare:

- > let customers exchange items
- > allow customers **to** exchange items

This distinction is very important.

B. ALLOW SOMEONE SOMETHING

5. **allow someone something — 准許 / 給予某人某事物**

This is the second construction used in your passage.

Practice 1 — passage-linked

> Customers should **be allowed one exchange**.

顧客應該**獲准換貨一次**。

Practice 2

> Each customer is allowed two return requests per month.

每名顧客每月**可以提出兩次退貨申請**。

MCQ-ready definition:

allow someone X = 准許某人擁有、使用或獲得 X

6. **allow someone a certain amount/time — 給予某人一定數量 / 時間**

Practice 1

> Candidates are **allowed thirty minutes**.

考生**有三十分鐘作答時間**。

Practice 2

> Customers should be allowed a reasonable period to inspect the goods.

顧客應獲得**合理時間檢查商品**。

7. **allow yourself something — 准許自己享用 / 擁有某事**

Practice 1

> She rarely **allows herself a day off**.

她很少**讓自己放一天假**。

Practice 2

> Allow yourself enough time to compare the options.

要**給自己足夠時間**比較不同選項。

C. ALLOW YOURSELF TO DO SOMETHING

8. **allow yourself to do something — 讓自己做某事**

Practice 1

> Allow yourself to reconsider the decision.

容許自己重新考慮這項決定。

Practice 2

> He never allowed himself to relax.

他從不**讓自己放鬆**。

This can involve:

- * permission,
- * emotional inhibition,
- * self-control.

9. **allow yourself to feel/think — 容許自己感受 / 思考**

Practice 1

> She finally allowed herself to feel disappointed.

她終於**容許自己承認失望的感受**。

Practice 2

> Good leaders allow themselves to question their own assumptions.

優秀領導者會**容許自己質疑自己的假設**。

D. ALLOW SOMETHING = PERMIT IT TO HAPPEN

10. **allow something — 容許某事發生 / 存在**

The subject grants permission, but no person is explicitly named.

Practice 1

> The policy **allows exchanges but not cash refunds**.

政策**容許換貨，但不容許現金退款**。

Practice 2

> The building does not allow smoking.

大樓**不准吸煙**。

MCQ-ready definition:

allow X = 規則 / 人容許 X 發生、存在或進行

11. **allow returns — 容許退貨**

Practice 1

> The revised policy would **allow limited returns**.

修訂政策將**容許有限度退貨**。

Practice 2

> Some retailers allow returns only within seven days.

有些零售商只**容許七天內退貨**。

12. **allow refunds — 容許退款**

Practice 1

> The policy allows refunds only for defective goods.

政策只在商品有缺陷時**容許退款**。

Practice 2

> Final-sale items do not normally allow refunds under this proposed system.

按照這個建議制度，清貨商品一般**不設退款**。

E. ALLOW ACCESS / ENTRY / USE

13. **allow access — 准許進入 / 使用**

Practice 1

> Membership **allows access to special discounts**.

會籍**讓會員可以享用特別折扣**。

Practice 2

> Only authorised staff are allowed access to the warehouse.

只有獲授權員工**可以進入倉庫**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****allow access = 讓某人能夠進入地方、系統或使用資源****

14. **allow entry — 准許進入**

Practice 1

> The pass **allows entry to the building**.

通行證**容許持有人進入大樓**。

Practice 2

> Visitors without identification will not be allowed entry.

沒有身份證明的訪客**不得進入**。

15. **allow use of something — 准許使用某物**

Practice 1

> The licence allows commercial use of the material.

許可證**容許把材料用於商業用途**。

Practice 2

> The policy does not allow personal use of company equipment.

政策**不准把公司設備作私人用途**。

F. ALLOW = MAKE POSSIBLE

16. **allow something to happen = make it possible — 使.....成為可能**

A major extension from permission.

Here, **allow** may have no idea of a conscious person “giving permission.”

Practice 1

> Online tracking **allows customers to see where their parcel is**.

網上追蹤功能**讓顧客可以查看包裹位置**。

Practice 2

> Clear records allow managers to identify unusual return patterns.

清晰紀錄**讓管理人員能夠識別異常退貨模式**。

MCQ-ready definition:

allow = 提供條件，使某件事情能夠發生或做到

17. **allow someone to see/understand/compare — 讓某人能夠看見 / 理解 / 比較**

Practice 1

> The report allows managers to compare return rates.

報告**讓管理人員能比較退貨率**。

Practice 2

> Transparent criteria allow customers to understand the policy.

透明準則**讓顧客理解政策**。

18. **allow something to develop/grow/spread — 讓某事發展 / 增長 / 擴散**

Practice 1

> Ignoring complaints can **allow distrust to grow**.

忽視投訴可能**讓不信任加劇**。

Practice 2

> Poor controls may allow abuse to spread.

控制不足可能**讓濫用情況擴散**。

Important distinction 1: **permission allow vs enablement allow**

Permission:

- > The manager **allowed customers to exchange items**.
- > 經理**准許**顧客換貨。

Enablement:

- > The website **allows customers to track orders**.
- > 網站**讓顧客能夠**追蹤訂單。

The website is not literally granting moral permission—it provides the capability.

G. ALLOW TIME

19. **allow time for something — 預留時間給某事**

A major practical use.

Practice 1

- > **Allow time for inspection** before issuing refunds.

退款前要**預留時間檢查商品**。

Practice 2

- > Please allow enough time for delivery.

請**預留足夠送貨時間**。

MCQ-ready definition:

allow time for X = 計劃時預先留出足夠時間讓 X 發生 / 完成

20. **allow enough time to do something — 預留足夠時間做某事**

Practice 1

- > Allow enough time to review the evidence.

要**預留足夠時間檢查證據**。

Practice 2

> Customers should allow enough time for return shipping.

顧客應**預留足夠退貨運送時間**。

21. **allow X days/weeks — 預計 / 預留 X 天 / 星期**

Practice 1

> Please **allow five working days** for the refund.

請**預留五個工作天**處理退款。

Practice 2

> Allow two weeks for delivery.

送貨請**預計需時兩星期**。

Here **allow** often means:

take into account that this amount of time may be necessary

H. ALLOW FOR = TAKE INTO ACCOUNT

22. **allow for something — 考慮到 ; 把.....計算在內**

A major phrasal/prepositional construction.

Practice 1

> The policy should **allow for genuine sizing problems**.

政策應**考慮到真實的尺碼問題**。

Practice 2

> The schedule allows for possible delays.

時間表已**把可能的延誤計算在內**。

MCQ-ready definition:

****allow for X = 計劃 / 計算時考慮 X 的存在或可能發生****

23. ****allow for differences — 考慮差異****

Practice 1

> Size charts should ****allow for differences in body shape****.

尺碼表應****考慮不同身形的差異****。

Practice 2

> The comparison should allow for differences in store size.

比較時應****把店舖規模差異考慮在內****。

24. ****allow for error — 預留誤差；考慮誤差****

Practice 1

> The calculation should ****allow for measurement error****.

計算應****考慮測量誤差****。

Practice 2

> Always allow for a small margin of error.

一定要****預留少量誤差空間****。

25. ****allow for growth — 預留增長空間****

Practice 1

> The system should be designed to ****allow for future growth****.

系統設計應****預留未來增長空間****。

Practice 2

> The budget allows for increased return volume.

預算已**考慮退貨量可能上升**。

Important distinction 2: **allow X vs allow for X**

Compare:

> The policy **allows exchanges**.

> 政策**容許換貨**。

versus:

> The policy **allows for exceptional cases**.

> 政策**考慮了特殊個案 / 為特殊個案留下空間**。

These are completely different constructions.

I. ALLOW OF

26. **allow of something = admit/permit the possibility of it — 容許；有……餘地**

Formal and much less common than **allow for**.

Practice 1

> The rule **allows of no exceptions**.

這項規則**不容許任何例外**。

Practice 2

> The evidence allows of several interpretations.

證據**容許有數種解讀**。

MCQ-ready definition:

allow of X = formal: 性質上容許 X 存在 / 成立

Most learners need mainly to **recognise** this construction.

27. **allow of no doubt / exception — 不容懷疑 / 例外**

Practice 1

> The wording **allows of no ambiguity**.

措辭**不容有歧義**。

Practice 2

> The rule allows of no exceptions.

規則**沒有例外餘地**。

Important distinction 3: **allow for vs allow of**

allow for

take into account:

> allow for delays

> 考慮延誤

allow of

formal: admit the possibility/existence of:

> allows of no exception

> 不容例外

Do not confuse them.

J. ALLOW THAT = ADMIT / CONCEDE

28. **allow that... = admit that... — 承認.....**

Formal, especially argumentative prose.

Practice 1

> Even critics **allow that the policy needs some flexibility**.

即使批評者也**承認政策需要一定彈性**。

Practice 2

> He allowed that the original rule had some advantages.

他**承認原本的規則也有一些優點**。

MCQ-ready definition:

allow that X = formal: 承認 X 是真的或有道理，即使自己未必完全同意

29. **allow the possibility that... — 承認有.....的可能性**

Practice 1

> We must **allow the possibility that some complaints are genuine**.

我們必須**承認有些投訴可能是真的**。

Practice 2

> The evidence allows the possibility of an alternative explanation.

證據**容許另一種解釋成立的可能性**。

Important distinction 4: **allow that vs concede that**

They are close.

concede that

more clearly indicates reluctant admission during disagreement.

allow that

formal/literary, often means accept/admit as possible or true.

Your passage itself later uses:

> **concede**

so this distinction is useful.

K. LEGAL / ADMINISTRATIVE: ALLOW A CLAIM

30. **allow a claim = formally accept/approve it — 批准 / 接納申索**

A major formal/legal/administrative sense.

Practice 1

> The insurer **allowed the claim**.

保險公司**批准了申索**。

Practice 2

> Only properly documented claims will be allowed.

只有文件齊全的申索才會**獲接納**。

MCQ-ready definition:

allow a claim = 有權機構正式認可某項申索有效 / 可獲處理

31. **allow an appeal — 准許 / 判上訴得直**

Legal sense.

Practice 1

> The court **allowed the appeal**.

法院**判上訴得直 / 批准上訴**。

Practice 2

> If the appeal is allowed, the earlier decision may be changed.

如果**上訴得直**，原本決定可能會改變。

Important legal nuance:

> **allow an appeal**

can mean more than merely “permit someone to file it”; it often means:

the appellate court accepts the appeal on its merits.

32. **allow an application/request — 批准申請 / 要求**

Practice 1

> The court allowed the application.

法院**批准了申請**。

Practice 2

> Management allowed the request for an extension.

管理層**批准延期要求**。

L. TAX / ACCOUNTING: ALLOW AN EXPENSE OR DEDUCTION

33. **allow an expense/deduction = accept it for calculation — 認可可扣除**

Practice 1

> The expense may be **allowed for tax purposes**.

該項開支在稅務上可能**獲准扣除**。

Practice 2

> The deduction was allowed.

該項扣除**獲得認可**。

MCQ-ready definition:

allow an expense/deduction = 稅務 / 會計上承認某筆開支或扣除符合規則

34. **allowable expense — 可扣除 / 可認可開支**

Practice 1

> Keep receipts for all **allowable expenses**.

保留所有**可扣除開支**的收據。

Practice 2

> Not every business cost is an allowable expense for every purpose.

並非所有商業成本在每種制度下都屬於**可扣除開支**。

35. **allowable deduction** — 可扣除項目

Practice 1

> The rules define which deductions are **allowable**.

規則界定哪些扣除項目**獲准認可**。

Practice 2

> The deduction was disallowed.

該項扣除**不獲認可**。

M. ALLOWABLE = PERMITTED

36. **allowable** = officially permitted — 容許的；可接受的

Practice 1

> The maximum **allowable return period** is thirty days.

最長**容許退貨期**是三十天。

Practice 2

> Only allowable expenses can be reimbursed.

只有**獲准的開支**才可以報銷。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****allowable = 根據規則、標準或法律可以接受 / 容許的****

37. ****allowable limit — 容許上限****

Practice 1

> The measurement exceeded the ****allowable limit****.

測量結果超過****容許上限****。

Practice 2

> Return abuse should remain below an allowable threshold.

退貨濫用情況應維持在****可接受限度****以下。

38. ****allowable range — 容許範圍****

Practice 1

> The value must remain within the ****allowable range****.

數值必須保持在****容許範圍****內。

Practice 2

> The system rejects values outside the allowable range.

系統會拒絕超出****可接受範圍****的數值。

39. ****allowable error — 容許誤差****

Practice 1

> The result is within the ****allowable error****.

結果在****容許誤差****範圍內。

Practice 2

> Allowable error depends on the measurement standard.

****容許誤差**取決於測量標準。**

N. ENGINEERING: ALLOWABLE STRESS / LOAD

40. ****allowable stress — 容許應力****

Practice 1

> The calculated stress must remain below the ****allowable stress****.

計算所得應力必須低於****容許應力****。

Practice 2

> Engineers compare actual and allowable stress.

工程師會比較實際應力和****容許應力****。

41. ****allowable load — 容許荷載****

Practice 1

> Do not exceed the ****allowable load****.

不要超過****容許荷載****。

Practice 2

> The allowable load depends on the structural design.

****容許荷載****取決於結構設計。

O. ALLOWED = PERMITTED

42. ****allowed = permitted by rules — 獲准的；容許的****

Practice 1

> Refunds are ****allowed only in specific cases****.

退款只在特定個案中****獲准****。

Practice 2

> No outside food is allowed.

****不准攜帶外來食物****。

43. ****maximum allowed — 最高容許****

Practice 1

> Two items is the ****maximum allowed****.

最多****只容許兩件商品****。

Practice 2

> The value exceeded the maximum allowed.

該數值超過****最高容許值****。

44. ****legally allowed — 法律容許的****

Practice 1

> The practice is ****legally allowed****.

這種做法在法律上****獲准****。

Practice 2

> Legally allowed does not necessarily mean advisable.

****法律容許****並不一定代表值得採用。

P. “NO X ALLOWED”

45. **no X allowed — 禁止 X**

A very common notice pattern.

Practice 1

> **No returns allowed after thirty days.**

三十天後**不接受退貨**。

Practice 2

> No photography allowed.

禁止攝影。

46. **X allowed — 准許 X**

Practice 1

> Exchanges allowed within fourteen days.

十四天內**可以換貨**。

Practice 2

> One return per order allowed.

每張訂單**只准退貨一次**。

This shortened sign-style grammar is common in notices.

Q. ALLOWANCE = REGULAR MONEY

47. **allowance = regular amount of money given to someone — 津貼；零用錢**

A major noun branch.

Practice 1

> She gives her child a weekly **allowance**.

她每星期給孩子**零用錢**。

Practice 2

> Employees receive a travel allowance.

員工可獲**交通津貼**。

MCQ-ready definition:

allowance = 定期給予某人，用於某項需要或個人開支的一筆金錢

48. **weekly/monthly allowance — 每週 / 每月零用錢 / 津貼**

Practice 1

> His weekly allowance is \$20.

他的每週**零用錢**是 20 元。

Practice 2

> Staff receive a monthly allowance for transport.

員工每月獲得一筆交通**津貼**。

49. **pocket-money allowance — 零用錢**

Practice 1

> Children may receive a small **allowance** for personal spending.

兒童可能會獲得少量**零用錢**。

Practice 2

> She saved part of her weekly allowance.

她把每週**零用錢**的一部分儲起來。

R. WORK / EXPENSE ALLOWANCES

50. **travel allowance — 交通 / 旅遊津貼**

Practice 1

> Employees receive a **travel allowance**.

員工可獲**交通津貼**。

Practice 2

> The allowance covers part of the travel cost.

這項**津貼**涵蓋部分交通費用。

51. **housing allowance — 住房津貼**

Practice 1

> The package includes a **housing allowance**.

薪酬福利包括**住房津貼**。

Practice 2

> Senior employees may receive a housing allowance.

資深員工可能獲得**房屋津貼**。

52. **meal allowance — 膳食津貼**

Practice 1

> Staff working late receive a **meal allowance**.

加班員工可獲**膳食津貼**。

Practice 2

> The meal allowance is capped per day.

每日**膳食津貼**設有上限。

53. **clothing allowance — 服裝津貼**

Practice 1

> Some employees receive a **clothing allowance**.

部分員工可獲**服裝津貼**。

Practice 2

> The allowance helps cover required work clothing.

津貼用於補貼工作服裝費用。

S. BAGGAGE ALLOWANCE

54. **baggage allowance — 行李限額**

A major travel sense.

Practice 1

> Check your **baggage allowance** before flying.

乘飛機前先查看你的**行李限額**。

Practice 2

> The ticket includes a 23-kilogram baggage allowance.

機票包括 23 公斤**行李額度**。

MCQ-ready definition:

baggage allowance = 航空公司准許旅客攜帶 / 托運而不另加費用或按特定條件計算的行李數量 / 重量

55. **carry-on allowance — 手提行李限額**

Practice 1

> The airline reduced its **carry-on allowance**.

航空公司降低了**手提行李限額**。

Practice 2

> Check the size as well as the weight allowance.

除重量外，也應檢查行李**尺寸限額**。

T. DUTY-FREE ALLOWANCE

56. **duty-free allowance** — **免稅限額**

Practice 1

> Travellers should check their **duty-free allowance**.

旅客應查看自己的**免稅限額**。

Practice 2

> Goods above the allowance may need to be declared.

超過**免稅額度**的商品可能需要申報。

MCQ-ready definition:

duty-free allowance = 旅客可在毋須繳付相關關稅 / 稅項的情況下攜帶的**限額**

Exact limits depend on jurisdiction.

U. TAX ALLOWANCE

57. **tax allowance** — **稅務免稅額 / 扣減額**

Practice 1

> The taxpayer may qualify for a **tax allowance**.

納稅人可能符合某項**稅務免稅額 / 扣減額**資格。

Practice 2

> Tax allowances vary between tax systems.

不同稅制的**免稅 / 扣減額**並不相同。

58. **personal allowance — 個人免稅額**

A term used in some tax systems.

Practice 1

> The system provides a **personal allowance**.

制度提供**個人免稅額**。

Practice 2

> The exact rules vary by jurisdiction and tax year.

實際**個人免稅額**規則會因地區和課稅年度而異。

59. **capital allowance — 資本免稅 / 資本折讓**

A tax/accounting term.

Practice 1

> Businesses may claim **capital allowances** on qualifying assets.

企業可能可以就合資格資產申索**資本免稅 / 資本折讓**。

Practice 2

> Capital allowance rules depend on the tax system.

資本折讓規則取決於相關稅制。

Important distinction 5: **allowance vs deduction**

allowance

an amount the rules permit/exempt.

deduction

amount deducted in calculating a taxable amount.

Tax terminology varies by jurisdiction, so do not assume every **allowance** functions exactly like every **deduction**.

V. MAKE ALLOWANCE FOR

60. **make allowance for something — 把.....考慮在內**

A major idiom closely related to **allow for**.

Practice 1

> We should **make allowance for delivery delays**.

我們應該**把送貨延誤考慮在內**。

Practice 2

> The size guide should make allowance for variation between fabrics.

尺碼指南應**考慮不同布料造成的差異**。

MCQ-ready definition:

make allowance for X = 評估 / 計劃時考慮 X 的影響

61. **make allowances for someone — 體諒某人；對某人寬容**

A related but distinct interpersonal sense.

Practice 1

> We should **make allowances for new staff** while they are learning.

新員工仍在學習時，我們應該**給予一定體諒**。

Practice 2

> Her colleagues made allowances for her lack of experience.

同事**體諒她經驗不足**。

MCQ-ready definition:

make allowances for someone = 因某人的處境、弱點或限制而降低要求 / 較為寬容

Important distinction 6: **make allowance for vs make allowances for**

Often:

singular **allowance**

emphasizes taking a factor into account:

> make allowance for error.

plural **allowances**

often emphasizes being forgiving toward people:

> make allowances for inexperienced staff.

But actual usage can overlap.

W. ALLOWANCE FOR ERROR / TOLERANCE

62. **allowance for error — 誤差容許量；預留誤差**

Practice 1

> The calculation includes an **allowance for error**.

計算包含**誤差容許量**。

Practice 2

> Build in an allowance for measurement uncertainty.

應**預留測量不確定性的誤差空間**。

63. **allowance = extra amount intentionally provided — 預留量；餘量**

Technical/general sense.

Practice 1

> The design includes a small **allowance for expansion**.

設計預留了一小段**膨脹餘量**。

Practice 2

> Add an allowance for waste when ordering material.

訂購材料時應加入**耗損預留量**。

MCQ-ready definition:

allowance = 為了應付變化、誤差、加工等而刻意多預留的量

X. MANUFACTURING / ENGINEERING ALLOWANCE

64. **machining allowance — 加工餘量**

Practice 1

> The part includes a **machining allowance**.

零件留有**加工餘量**。

Practice 2

> Extra material is left as machining allowance.

會額外保留材料作為**加工餘量**。

65. **tolerance vs allowance — 公差 vs 配合餘量**

In engineering these can have distinct technical meanings.

tolerance

permitted variation from a nominal dimension.

allowance

intentional difference between mating dimensions or deliberately provided extra amount, depending on engineering context.

Learners should not treat them as exact synonyms.

Y. SEWING: SEAM ALLOWANCE

66. **seam allowance — 縫份**

A major fashion/sewing term—especially relevant to this passage's clothing domain.

Practice 1

> Leave a **seam allowance** around the edge.

邊緣要預留**縫份**。

Practice 2

> The pattern includes a 1.5-centimetre seam allowance.

紙樣已包括 1.5 厘米**縫份**。

MCQ-ready definition:

seam allowance = 裁剪布料時，縫線外額外保留、用來縫合的布料寬度

67. **include/exclude seam allowance — 包含 / 不包含縫份**

Practice 1

> Check whether the pattern **includes seam allowance**.

查看紙樣是否**已包含縫份**。

Practice 2

> Add seam allowance before cutting.

裁剪前先**加上縫份**。

Z. ACCOUNTING: ALLOWANCE FOR DOUBTFUL ACCOUNTS

68. **allowance for doubtful accounts — 呆帳準備 / 預期壞帳備抵**

A major accounting sense.

Practice 1

> The company increased its **allowance for doubtful accounts**.

公司增加了**呆帳準備 / 壞帳備抵**。

Practice 2

> The allowance reflects expected amounts that may not be collected.

這項**備抵**反映可能無法收回的預期款項。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****allowance for doubtful accounts = 為預期部分應收款可能無法收回而作出的會計備抵****

Terminology varies by accounting framework/local usage.

AA. DISALLOW

69. **disallow = officially refuse to permit/accept — 不准許；不予認可；駁回**

The main opposite derivative.

Practice 1

> The policy **disallows returns on worn items**.

政策**不允許穿過的商品退貨**。

Practice 2

> The claim was disallowed.

該項申索**不獲批准**。

****MCQ-ready definition:****

****disallow X = 正式判定 X 不獲准、不被接受或不符合規則****

70. ****disallow a claim — 駁回 / 不接納申索****

Practice 1

> The insurer ****disallowed the claim**** because evidence was insufficient.

保險公司因證據不足而****拒絕該項申索****。

Practice 2

> Claims may be disallowed if conditions are not met.

如果條件不符，申索可能****不獲接納****。

71. ****disallow an expense/deduction — 不認可開支 / 扣除****

Practice 1

> The tax authority ****disallowed the expense****.

稅務機關****不認可該項開支作扣除****。

Practice 2

> The deduction was disallowed.

該項扣除****被否決****。

AB. SPORTS: DISALLOW A GOAL

72. ****disallow a goal/point — 判入球 / 得分無效****

A major sports sense.

Practice 1

> The referee **disallowed the goal**.

球證**判入球無效**。

Practice 2

> The goal was disallowed for offside.

該入球因越位而**被判無效**。

MCQ-ready definition:

disallow a goal = 裁判正式判定該入球 / 得分不成立

73. **disallowed goal — 被判無效的入球**

Practice 1

> The team had two **disallowed goals**.

球隊有兩個**被判無效的入球**。

Practice 2

> The disallowed goal changed the momentum of the match.

這個**無效入球**改變了比賽形勢。

AC. SPORTS: ALLOW A GOAL / RUN / HIT

74. **allow a goal/run/hit = concede it — 被對方取得得分 / 容許對方得分**

Especially AmE sports/statistical usage.

Practice 1

> The team **allowed three goals**.

球隊**被對手攻入三球**。

Practice 2

> The pitcher allowed only two hits.

投手只**被擊出兩支安打**。

MCQ-ready definition:

allow X in sport = 未能阻止對手取得 X ; 被對方得到某項得分 / 成果

This is not literal “permission.”

Important distinction 7: **allow a goal vs disallow a goal**

team allows a goal

defence fails to prevent opponent scoring.

referee disallows a goal

referee rules that apparent goal does not count.

Completely different relationships.

AD. PERMISSION EXPRESSIONS

75. **X is allowed — X 是准許的**

Practice 1

> Exchanges are allowed.

可以換貨。

Practice 2

> Photography is allowed.

准許攝影。

76. **X is not allowed — X 是不准的**

Practice 1

> Cash refunds are not allowed in change-of-mind cases.

因改變主意而要求的現金退款**不獲准許**。

Practice 2

> Returned goods must not show signs of wear.

退貨商品**不得**有穿着痕跡。

77. **be allowed in/on/at — 在某地方 / 場合獲准**

Practice 1

> Food is not allowed in the warehouse.

倉庫內**禁止飲食**。

Practice 2

> Customers are allowed in the fitting area.

顧客**可以進入試身區**。

AE. ALLOW VS LET

Important distinction 8: **allow vs let**

allow

more neutral/formal:

> The policy allows customers to exchange items.

let

more conversational:

> The policy lets customers exchange items.

Grammar:

> allow someone ****to do****

> let someone ****do****

So:

> allow me ****to explain**** ✓

> let me ****explain**** ✓

> *let me to explain* ✗

Important distinction 9: ****allow vs permit****

****permit****

more formal/official.

****allow****

broader and more common.

> smoking is not allowed

> everyday

> smoking is not permitted

> more formal/sign-like

They overlap strongly.

Important distinction 10: ****allow vs authorize****

****allow****

give permission.

****authorize****

officially give legal/organizational authority.

> staff are allowed to inspect items

> 准許檢查

- > manager is authorized to approve refunds
- > 獲正式授權批准退款

Authorization is generally stronger and more formal.

Important distinction 11: **allow** vs **approve**

allow

permit activity.

approve

formally accept a request/proposal.

- > allow returns
- > 容許退貨

- > approve a return request
- > 批准退貨申請

This is especially relevant to your passage.

Important distinction 12: **allow** vs **grant**

grant

formally give something requested/right/permission.

allow

permit.

- > grant an extension
- > 正式批准延期

- > allow extra time
- > 容許多些時間

Important distinction 13: **allow** vs **enable**

allow

can mean permission **or** make possible.

enable

specifically give the means/capability.

> policy allows refund

> 政策准許退款

> software enables automatic refund processing

> 軟件令自動退款處理成為可能

Important distinction 14: **allow** vs **make possible**

In:

> The data allows us to identify patterns.

No one is “giving permission.”

It means:

> The data **makes identification possible**.

This is one of the most important figurative extensions.

Important distinction 15: **allow** vs **tolerate**

allow

do not prohibit.

tolerate

endure/accept something undesirable.

> management allows flexible hours

> 准許彈性工時

- > management tolerates occasional lateness
- > 容忍偶爾遲到

Tolerance often implies:

- > “I do not particularly like it, but I put up with it.”

Important distinction 16: **allow** vs **accept**

allow

permission.

accept

receive/agree to recognize.

- > allow returns
- > 容許退貨

- > accept a returned item
- > 接受退回商品

Important distinction 17: **allow** vs **admit**

Admission/entry:

- > allow someone in
- > 讓某人進入

Truth:

- > admit that X is true
- > 承認 X

Formal **allow that** can overlap with **admit**, but this is not the normal core use.

AF. ALLOW FOR VS CONSIDER

Important distinction 18: **allow for vs consider**

consider X

think about X.

allow for X

actually incorporate X into:

- * calculation,
- * plan,
- * expectation.

> consider possible delays

> 考慮一下延誤

> allow for possible delays

> **把延誤正式預留 / 計入計劃**

The second is more operational.

Important distinction 19: **allow for vs account for**

These overlap in “take into account.”

allow for X

make provision for X.

account for X

can mean:

1. take X into account;
2. explain X;
3. constitute a proportion.

So:

> allow for returns

> 預留退貨因素

> returns account for 15% of sales

> 退貨佔銷售 15%

Different.

AG. ALLOWANCE VS ALLOW

Important distinction 20: **allowance is not simply "permission"**

Although related historically, modern **allowance** has many lexicalized senses:

- * money,
- * permitted quantity,
- * tax relief,
- * baggage limit,
- * engineering extra amount,
- * consideration/tolerance.

For ordinary permission, English normally says:

> permission

not:

> *an allowance to do something*

Important distinction 21: **allowance vs permission**

permission

right/approval to do something.

allowance

usually:

- * money,
- * amount,
- * limit,
- * adjustment.

> permission to return an item

> 退貨許可

> baggage allowance

> 行李限額

Important distinction 22: **allowance vs limit**

allowance

amount you are permitted.

limit

maximum boundary.

Example:

> baggage allowance = 23 kg

> baggage limit = maximum permitted weight

They can refer to similar quantities but from different perspectives.

Important distinction 23: **allowance vs quota**

allowance

permitted amount.

quota

fixed required/permitted allocation, often within a system.

> baggage allowance

> import quota

Not synonyms.

AH. MAKE ALLOWANCES VS EXCUSE

Important distinction 24: **make allowances for vs excuse**

make allowances for someone

adjust expectations because of circumstances.

excuse behaviour

forgive/not blame it.

> make allowances for a new employee's inexperience

> 體諒新員工缺乏經驗

does not mean:

> every mistake is automatically excused.

Important distinction 25: **make allowances for vs sympathize**

sympathize

feel understanding/compassion.

make allowances

change judgment/expectations because of that circumstance.

One is feeling; the other affects evaluation.

AI. ALLOWED VS ALLOWABLE

Important distinction 26: **allowed vs allowable**

allowed

actually permitted under a rule:

> Returns are allowed.

allowable

capable of being permitted/accepted under rules or within limits:

> allowable expense

> allowable error

****Allowable**** sounds more technical/formal.

Important distinction 27: ****allowable vs acceptable****

****allowable****

within permitted rules/limits.

****acceptable****

satisfactory enough.

Something can be:

> allowable but undesirable

or:

> acceptable but not formally allowable

depending on rules.

Important distinction 28: ****allowable vs legal****

****legal****

permitted by law.

****allowable****

permitted by a particular:

- * rule,
- * standard,
- * calculation,
- * policy.

A retailer may disallow something even though it is not illegal.

AJ. DISALLOW VS BAN

Important distinction 29: ****disallow vs ban****

****disallow****

formally refuse/declare invalid in a specific case or rule system.

****ban****

prohibit broadly.

> disallow a refund claim

> 拒絕某宗退款申請

> ban returns entirely

> 全面禁止退貨

Important distinction 30: ****disallow vs reject****

****reject****

refuse to accept.

****disallow****

officially decide not permitted/valid.

> reject a proposal

> 拒絕方案

> disallow a tax deduction

> 不認可稅務扣除

AK. PASSAGE-SPECIFIC: “ALLOWED TO CHANGE THEIR MINDS”

78. ****allow someone to change their mind — 容許某人改變主意****

Practice 1 — original

> Customers should not necessarily ****be allowed to change their minds without limit****.

不一定應該讓顧客**毫無限制地改變主意**。

Practice 2

> A fair policy can allow customers to change their minds within defined limits.

公平政策可以在明確限制內**容許顧客改變主意**。

Here, **allow** concerns:

permission under commercial policy

not:

- * capability,
- * timing,
- * allowance,
- * formal admission.

79. **without limit — unlimited permission**

The phrase matters.

The letter does **not** advocate:

> unlimited permission.

It argues for:

conditional permission

That distinction is central:

> allowed — but only under stated conditions.

AL. PASSAGE-SPECIFIC: “ALLOWED ONE EXCHANGE”

80. **be allowed one exchange — 獲准有一次換貨**

Practice 1 — original passage

> Customers should ****be allowed one exchange for size or colour****.

顧客應****獲准因尺碼或顏色換貨一次****。

Practice 2

> Each order is allowed one discretionary exchange.

每張訂單****可酌情換貨一次****。

This construction:

> ****allow someone + noun****

expresses:

permitted quantity/entitlement

rather than:

> allow someone to + verb.

Important distinction 31: ****allowed one exchange vs allowed to exchange once****

These are semantically close:

> Customers are ****allowed one exchange****.

> 顧客****有一次換貨機會****。

> Customers are ****allowed to exchange once****.

> 顧客****可以換貨一次****。

The first treats:

> ****one exchange****

as the permitted entitlement.

The second treats:

> ****exchange****

as the permitted action.

AM. POLICY LANGUAGE

81. **allow only if... — 只有在.....情況下才容許**

Practice 1

> Returns should be **allowed only if the item is unworn**.

只有商品未穿過才應**准許退貨**。

Practice 2

> Refunds are allowed only when the item is defective.

只有商品有缺陷時才**容許退款**。

82. **allow subject to conditions — 在附帶條件下准許**

Practice 1

> Exchanges may be allowed **subject to inspection**.

換貨可以在**須先檢查的條件下獲准**。

Practice 2

> Returns are allowed subject to the stated conditions.

退貨須符合列明條件才**獲准**。

83. **conditionally allow — 有條件地容許**

Practice 1

> The proposal would **conditionally allow returns**.

方案會**有條件地容許退貨**。

Practice 2

> Rather than imposing a blanket ban, management could allow limited returns.

管理層可以容許**有限度退貨**，而非全面禁止。

Important distinction 32: **allow vs require**

Excellent policy contrast.

allow

person may do it.

require

person must do it.

> customers are allowed to provide photos

> 顧客可以提供照片

> customers are required to provide photos

> 顧客**必須**提供照片

Permission ≠ obligation.

Important distinction 33: **allow vs entitle**

allow

policy permits.

entitle

person has a right/claim to something under a rule/law.

> policy allows one exchange

> 政策容許一次換貨

> customer is entitled to a refund

> 顧客**有權獲得退款**

Entitle is stronger because it emphasizes right, not mere discretion.

Important distinction 34: ****allow vs qualify for****

From your ****return**** entry:

****allow returns****

policy permits the category/action.

****qualify for return****

this particular item/customer satisfies the eligibility conditions.

So:

- > policy allows returns
- > does not mean
- > every item qualifies for return.

Very important for this passage.

Important distinction 35: ****allow vs discretionary permission****

Your passage proposes:

- > discretionary exchanges

A policy may:

****allow staff to exercise discretion****

but this means staff have permission to make judgments.

It does ****not**** mean customers automatically have a guaranteed right to every exception.

AN. “ALLOW” IN A MORE ABSTRACT CAUSAL SENSE

84. ****allow a problem to continue — 讓問題持續****

Practice 1

> Management should not **allow complaints to accumulate**.

管理層不應**讓投訴不斷累積**。

Practice 2

> Weak controls allowed return abuse to continue.

薄弱的控制措施**令退貨濫用得以持續**。

85. **allow something to become X — 讓某事變成 X**

Practice 1

> We should not **allow a minor sizing issue to become a major dispute**.

我們不應**讓小小的尺碼問題演變成重大爭議**。

Practice 2

> Poor communication allowed frustration to become distrust.

溝通不足**讓挫折感演變成不信任**。

86. **allow something to remain — 讓某事保持某狀態**

Practice 1

> The current policy allows distrust to remain unresolved.

現有政策**讓不信任持續存在**。

Practice 2

> Good procedures should not allow defective goods to remain in circulation.

良好程序不應**讓有缺陷商品繼續流通**。

AO. IMPORTANT REGISTER NOTE

****Allow**** ranges from ordinary to formal:

Everyday:

> My parents don't allow me to stay out late.

Workplace:

> The system allows staff to approve returns.

Legal/formal:

> The court allowed the appeal.

Technical:

> allowable stress

> allowance for error

So its meaning shifts heavily according to:

* grammar,

* subject,

* object,

* domain.

Important distinction 36: ****allow** does not always mean “approve of”

This is subtle but important.

If someone:

> allows X

they permit it.

They do ****not necessarily personally agree with or like X****.

Example:

> Management allows remote work.

does not necessarily mean:

> Management believes remote work is always ideal.

Permission and approval in the evaluative sense are different.

Important distinction 37: **allow** does not mean “encourage”

allow

do not prevent.

encourage

actively promote.

Your passage argues that permitting limited returns does **not** necessarily mean:

> encouraging abuse.

This is actually central to Chris's argument.

> **allow conditional returns**

> ≠

> **encourage customers to abuse the system**

Important distinction 38: **allow** does not mean “guarantee”

allow X

make X permitted/possible.

guarantee X

ensure X happens/is provided.

> policy allows exchanges

> does not mean every exchange request will automatically succeed.

Inspection may still be required.

Important distinction 39: **allow** vs **safeguard**

The proposal deliberately combines:

> **allow** legitimate returns

with:

> safeguards that **prevent** abuse.

So the policy does not have to choose between:

> complete prohibition

> and

> unlimited permission.

The argument is for:

controlled permission

Family-extension note

The **allow** family has several major modern branches:

1. **permission**

* allow someone to do X

* be allowed to do X

2. **permitted entitlement**

* allow someone one exchange

* allow someone extra time

3. **self-permission**

* allow yourself to rest

4. **permit an activity**

* allow returns

* allow smoking

5. **make possible**

* technology allows users to...

6. **planning time**

- * allow time for
- * allow five days

7. **take into account**

- * allow for delays
- * allow for error

8. **formal possibility**

- * allow of no exception

9. **formal admission**

- * allow that...

10. **legal approval**

- * allow a claim
- * allow an appeal

11. **tax/accounting recognition**

- * allowable expense
- * allow a deduction

12. **permitted limits**

- * allowable limit
- * allowable error

13. **engineering**

- * allowable stress
- * allowable load

14. **money given regularly**

- * allowance
- * travel allowance

15. **permitted quantity**

- * baggage allowance
- * duty-free allowance

16. **tax relief**

- * personal allowance
- * capital allowance

17. **consideration/forgiveness**

- * make allowance for
- * make allowances for

18. **technical extra amount**

- * machining allowance
- * allowance for expansion

19. **fashion/sewing**

- * seam allowance

20. **accounting**

- * allowance for doubtful accounts

21. **formal refusal**

- * disallow a claim
- * disallow a deduction

22. **sports**

- * disallow a goal
- * allow a goal/run/hit

For your passage, the exact branch is:

allow = grant a customer permission or a defined entitlement under the retailer's policy

Master comparison

| Form / expression

| Traditional Chinese | Core idea

|

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allow someone to do X	允許某人做 X	passage sense
be allowed to do X	獲准做 X	permission
not be allowed to X	不得做 X	prohibition
allow someone X	准許某人獲得 X	entitlement
allow one exchange	准許換貨一次	passage
allow someone time	給某人時間	entitlement
allow yourself X	准許自己享用 X	self-permission
allow yourself to X	讓自己做 X	self-permission
allow returns	容許退貨	policy
allow refunds	容許退款	policy
allow access	准許存取 / 進入	access
allow entry	准許進入	access
allow use	准許使用	permission
allow (enable)	使.....成為可能	capability
allow customers to track	讓顧客能追蹤	enablement
allow time for X	預留時間給 X	planning
allow five days	預計 / 預留五天	timing
allow for X	把 X 考慮在內	planning
allow for delays	考慮延誤	planning
allow for error	預留誤差	calculation
allow of X	正式：容許 X 成立	formal
allow of no exception	不容例外	formal
allow that...	承認.....	formal admission
allow a claim	批准申索	legal/admin
allow an appeal	判上訴得直 / 批准上訴	law
allow an application	批准申請	administration
allow an expense	認可開支	tax/accounting
allowable	容許 / 可接受的	formal adjective
allowable expense	可扣除開支	tax
allowable limit	容許上限	technical
allowable range	容許範圍	technical
allowable error	容許誤差	technical
allowable stress	容許應力	engineering
allowed	獲准的	permission
maximum allowed	最高容許	limit
no X allowed	禁止 X	sign/rule
allowance (money)	津貼；零用錢	money
weekly allowance	每週零用錢	money
travel allowance	交通 / 旅遊津貼	employment
housing allowance	房屋津貼	employment
meal allowance	膳食津貼	employment
baggage allowance	行李限額	travel
duty-free allowance	免稅限額	customs
tax allowance	稅務免稅 / 扣減額	tax
personal allowance	個人免稅額	tax

capital allowance	資本折讓	tax	
make allowance for X	把 X 考慮在內	consideration	
make allowances for someone	體諒某人	tolerance	
allowance for error	誤差預留量	technical	
machining allowance	加工餘量	engineering	
seam allowance	縫份	fashion/sewing	
allowance for doubtful accounts	呆帳準備 / 備抵	accounting	
disallow	不准許；駁回	opposite	
disallow a claim	駁回申索	legal/admin	
disallow a deduction	不認可扣除	tax	
disallow a goal	判入球無效	sport	
allow a goal/run	被對方得分	sport	

For your original passage

The first sentence is:

> At issue is not whether customers should **be allowed to change their minds without limit**, but whether our present rule is proportionate for online fashion.

Here:

be allowed to change their minds = 政策是否給顧客「改變主意後退換商品」的許可

The letter rejects:

> **unlimited allowance**

but supports:

> **conditional permission**

Later:

> Customers should **be allowed one exchange** for size or colour if the item is unworn and unwashed.

Here:

be allowed one exchange = 每名符合條件的顧客獲得一次換貨機會 / 權限

A natural Traditional Chinese rendering is:

> 問題並不是應否讓顧客**毫無限制地改變主意**，而是我們現行規則是否合乎比例。.....如果商

品未經穿着或清洗，顧客應**獲准因尺碼或顏色換貨一次**。

The cleanest learner contrast is:

- > **allow** = **容許 / 給予許可**
- > **let** = 讓，較口語
- > **permit** = 准許，較正式
- > **authorize** = 正式授權
- > **approve** = 批准某項申請 / 方案
- > **entitle** = 令某人依法 / 按規則享有權利
- > **enable** = 提供能力或條件，使事情能做到
- > **allow for** = **考慮到 / 預留**，不是「准許」
- > **allowance** = 津貼 / 限額 / 預留量等，不等於普通的 permission

And the passage's central policy logic is especially useful:

- > **allow limited returns**
- > ≠ **allow unlimited returns**
- > ≠ **encourage return abuse**

The proposal is built around **controlled permission**: customers are allowed a remedy, but only when stated conditions, evidence, inspection rules and limits are satisfied.